

limited to these asset classes. When starting your journey to FI, your biggest asset is human capital, not financial capital.

We define FI as the time when work becomes optional, but your ability to earn money by working is the engine that drives the train to this destination. Therefore, it's worth applying this idea of compound growth to your biggest initial investment: your career.

ESI Money is written anonymously by the former president of a \$100 million corporation. *ESI* focuses on how to grow your career and maximize earning power. On the *ChooseFI* podcast, he introduced the idea that “your career is a multimillion-dollar asset.” And he shared the math to prove his point. He calculated that someone with a starting salary of \$35,000 per year, earning an average pay raise of 3 percent per year, and working for forty-five years will make \$3.2 million over their working lifetime. Understanding the value of your career emphasizes the need to nurture, grow, and maximize its value.

Many people sleepwalk through life assuming they can just work hard and be treated fairly. Except it doesn't always work that way. Even when it does, it can lock you into the typical lifetime of mandatory work so well known to those on the standard path